

Philip Dauphin - 60 Minute Meeting-20260528_130548-Meeting Transcript

May 28, 2026, 5:05PM

56m 48s

● **Rick Snide** started transcription

● **+16*****04** 0:03
Tr...

 **Rick Snide** 0:06
Did you hear me?

● **+16*****04** 0:08
Yeah, that just is that is that Teams that said it was being transcribed? It was weird because it just...

 **Rick Snide** 0:14
The.
The.

● **+16*****04** 0:17
Something just popped in.

 **Rick Snide** 0:19
Yeah, that is Teams. I was gonna ask if you mind if I just used it to take notes. I'm not recording the call, I'm just having it take notes.

● **+16*****04** 0:26
No, not at all. Yeah, no, that's perfectly fine.

 **Rick Snide** 0:31
Okay, good, good. Makes it easier. I don't have to try to...



+16*****04 0:33

Book.



Rick Snide 0:36

Write things down while we chat.



+16*****04 0:39

Now, are you from Columbus originally?



Rick Snide 0:43

I am, yep, I am.



+16*****04 0:45

Where did you go to high school?



Rick Snide 0:48

Whetstone.



+16*****04 0:50

Wetstone, okay. So what year did you graduate from Wetstone?



Rick Snide 0:55

78



+16*****04 0:58

I graduated from Thomas Worthington in 87.



Rick Snide 1:01

Okay.



+16*****04 1:03

But I had quite a few friends that were my age that graduate from Whetstone, so...



Rick Snide 1:10

Yeah, yeah, it had been, it's kind of the same era.



+16***04** 1:11

Yeah.

Yeah.

Yeah, there's uh, do you remember a guy named David Mumaw from Whetstone at all?



Rick Snide 1:22

I remember his name. I don't remember him specifically, but I remember the Mumaw name. I think they lived in...

Lived in the Knolls. I lived in the Knolls, if you know where that is.
which is like across that river from Whetstone.



+16***04** 1:39

Sure.

Yeah, so Dave back in the day played baseball. He was a pitcher at Whetstone and then went to Ohio State and played some baseball too. But kind of a unique name, so I thought you may recognize it.



Rick Snide 1:44

Yeah.

Okay, mhm.

Yeah, I do. I've got a good friend that grew up across the street from me that it's funny, every time I talk to him, he's got somebody that he's run into or whatever, says, you remember, you know, Joe Smith? I'm like, mm. But I think.

I think his, I think he hasn't really done anything since high school, so all those memories are vivid for him, you know.



+16***04** 2:23

I've got a friend from Worthington the same way. I'll get text messages from him at 10 o'clock at night. I'll see him in the morning. And I'm just like, whoa, Eric, I mean, what the heck's going on? And matter of fact,



Rick Snide 2:29

Yeah.

Mm-hmm.



+16***04** 2:42

He went to Whetstone. That's ironic. He actually, he graduated from Whetstone in 88, I believe it was. So, Buchanan, Eric Buchanan.



Rick Snide 2:43

Oh.

What's his last name?

I don't know him. I kind of, I was, I actually left early and joined the Navy and I was long, long gone by really even, you know, the early 80s.

So...



+16***04** 3:07

Oh, sure. How long were you in the Navy?



Rick Snide 3:10

Technically 6 years, 6 1/2 really. My obligation was three years active and two years reserves, but I actually stayed in the reserves longer.



+16***04** 3:13

Okay.



Rick Snide 3:24

And, uh, and then that was that was it, though I only did one tour.

So, that was...



+16***04** 3:30

Helen, so you came back and settled back in the Columbus, huh?



Rick Snide 3:36

Yeah, I, you know, I look back now and I think, why the heck didn't I go and...

Go someplace different, but you know I just, I was in a hurry to... you know, get back. This is where my friends were and, you know, I was in a hurry to get to go to college and, you know, get that part of life under my belt. And for some reason, it didn't really occur to me to say, you know what, I like it over here in, you know, Japan or whatever. Why don't I just stay here? You know?

 **+16*****04** 4:06

Right, right. Well, it's I love Columbus, I love Central Ohio, grew up here. And then went and and did my thing professionally for seven years, and you know...

 **Rick Snide** 4:23
Mm-hmm.

 **+16*****04** 4:25

Came back here, and here I am. You know, it's amazing, so...

 **Rick Snide** 4:28
Mm.
Yeah.

 **+16*****04** 4:30

We actually, my wife and I bought the house that I grew up in when we were looking for our first house. And my parents were retiring, moving down to Florida, and so we bought it and actually just sold it three years ago, four years ago.

 **Rick Snide** 4:36
Yeah.
Mhm.
Is that right?

 **+16*****04** 4:49

Yeah, it's crazy. I was in that house for my entire childhood, and then when I came back and we bought it, lived there for another twenty-six years, so a lot of time spent in that place.



Rick Snide 5:02

Mm.

Yeah, I actually was, I actually grew up, my very first part of my life, I was in, I lived in Worthington. So we had a place on, my parents and when I was a little kid had a place on Meadoway Park, which was, I forget what, the Colonial Hills, right?



+16***04** 5:05

Yeah.

Oh yeah!



Rick Snide 5:24

which is, which is, it was a very nice little middle class neighborhood. It was a good, it was a good spot. And then we moved over to where, where I finished out my childhood over there in the Knolls. So yeah, it was,



+16***04** 5:24

Yeah, yeah.

Yeah, I loved it. It was almost dealing for a while with Colonial Hills. Evening Street, Colonial Hills, that entire area. I always enjoyed it.



Rick Snide 5:48

Mhm, mhm.

Yeah, yeah, it was a, it was a nice area, it really was.



+16***04** 5:55

Yeah.



Rick Snide 5:59

So, um, yeah, I was gonna say, I was gonna ask you, um, maybe tell me what, uh...



+16***04** 5:59

So, so tell me, I'm sorry, go ahead.



Rick Snide 6:09

Tell me.

what you have heard about us to this point and maybe what sounds interesting to you.



+16***04** 6:18

Well, I was sharing with with Ken. I've been in the industry and especially, you know, here in central Ohio for.



Rick Snide 6:24

Mhm.



+16***04** 6:30

I should date myself, but 25 years. And so across that time, you have a chance to hear different things about different companies. Obviously, I can share with you that everything I've heard has been extremely positive. So



Rick Snide 6:34

Mhm, mhm.

Mhm.

Well, that's good.



+16***04** 6:50

Great job on that. Kudos to you and the team. But I'm telling you, it's as you know, it is not.

easy to get a reputation as an outstanding company. It's a constant grind and the one time you mess up, all of a sudden 20 people know. And so it's what I've heard has been great. What I'd like to understand a little bit.



Rick Snide 7:04

Yeah.

Yeah.



+16***04** 7:19

More is so predominantly managed IT services. Rick, is that is that right? OK, OK, so and...



Rick Snide 7:26

Right.

Right, right.



+16***04** 7:32

In doing that, is it working with?

Oh, small to mid-size companies, mid-size to large, is it...



Rick Snide 7:43

Yeah, you're.



+16***04** 7:43

Is there a sector you go after?



Rick Snide 7:46

There, so let me just fill in a little bit more of that background for you. So we, at one point about, I guess it would have been three years ago, we had about 100 people and about a...



+16***04** 7:54

Sure.



Rick Snide 8:06

A third of them were Salesforce consulting.

And so we had a say we had a whole business of that. We actually had another business of NetSuite consulting also, but we shut that down, decided we were never going to make money on that one. But we had a Salesforce consulting business, which we sold about three years ago.



+16***04** 8:11

Yep, yep.



Rick Snide 8:33

And then we had a, there's a manufacturing software solution that you never would

have heard of called Plex, which is a Detroit, or not Detroit, but out suburbs of Detroit software company.

They were purchased by Rockwell Automation.

three, four years ago. We, we, so they were purchased, so we actually sold our.



+16***04** 8:57

Oh, okay.

Well...

Found.



Rick Snide 9:06

consulting group that specialized in implementing and adding on to that Plex software solution. We sold them actually, let me look, 28 days ago. So yeah, yeah.



+16***04** 9:23

Oh, really? Well, congratulations.



Rick Snide 9:26

So the remaining business, if you want to say it that way, is our managed services business. So that's kind of, if you, you know, kind of...



+16***04** 9:34

Okay.



Rick Snide 9:37

here around or read about things. In fact, we haven't even, we haven't cleaned up our website yet to remove the ERP business. But that all being said.
Um...



+16***04** 10:06

Sure.



Rick Snide 10:08

managed IT security and support for small and medium-sized businesses. And when I say small and medium-sized businesses, I really mean SMB and mid-market. But we...

 **+16*****04** 10:16
Okay.

 **Rick Snide** 10:26
Primarily we're in SMB and by SMB I mean we prefer 20 employees to 200 or so employees where we are fully managing all their IT.
And then as they get larger and move into maybe the more mid-market size, we like to offer what we call co-managed IT. And so we will, in that case, every one of them is a custom.

 **+16*****04** 10:59
Sure.

 **Rick Snide** 11:05
You know, a custom proposal, but it's the way we like it to be is that that customer will maintain a help desk to do the level one kind of help and maybe level 2, you know, of incoming support calls. And then our team will take the escalations from there. And our team will provide, typically we can provide all the security software to protect everything and the security training.
And we'll take care of the whole infrastructure, the Wi-Fi and network servers and cloud servers and all that kind of stuff, which requires a pretty highly skilled team. Team to take care of all that stuff in the back, you know, the back end side of the business.
So, that's what we call co-managed.
And we have really a handful of customers that do that, but we'd like to do more of that. I think that's a growth area that you know that we've seen that makes sense for a lot of customers, so we do that, I'd say.
We've been, because of our history, we've had a number of manufacturing customers as our clients, but we actually have quite a few.
Um...
companies that are in professional services, so legal and Accounting and wealth management. So, you know, all in professional services is a good area because, you know, there's that their business is working on the computers. So.
Usually, that's usually a very good fit for us.

Um...

And then we actually have a lot of not-for-profits also.

 **+16*****04** 13:18
Oh, really? Okay.

 **Rick Snide** 13:20
Mhm.

 **+16*****04** 13:22
So, the the manufacturing are those.
Within Central Ohio, or spread out throughout, you know, 50 states.

 **Rick Snide** 13:33
Typically, typically in just central Ohio, and the some of our managed services customers have, we do have some that are not in Ohio, and we do have some that are branches of...

 **+16*****04** 13:39
Okay.

 **Rick Snide** 13:51
customers that are here. Typically, that's how it goes for us is we'll land them here as an account and then, you know, they'll have a satellite office or a, you know, a sister company or whatever, you know, in some other city and we'll take that one on too. Or, you know, we have a couple of situations where our main contact was the CFO or whatever, and that person left and went to, you know, some other business somewhere and, you know, decided that, you know, they wanted to have us. service them at that new customer as well. And in that case, we've got, I think we've got one in DC that's like that. I think we've got one in... kind of near Chicago that's like that or near Milwaukee I guess it's like that. But, primarily, it's... local or central Ohio-ish companies.
For the main reason that we have, we felt like we needed to be able to get to them

within a couple of hours, you know, if they had some, you know, problem that couldn't be fixed remotely.

 **+16*****04** 15:09
Sure.

 **Rick Snide** 15:17
But I mean, that's becoming less and less important, you know, I think, and you see, you know, that people can get by with getting remote IT support and...
If you have somebody that can go unplug something or, you know, move something around, that usually can handle, you know, any of the on-site type work that needs to get done.
So, long answer to a short question.

 **+16*****04** 15:44
Oh, sure.
Oh, I love it. Thank you for sharing. So it's great information to know because I'd asked Ken along the lines too, just background and I didn't realize.

 **Rick Snide** 15:51
Mhm.

 **+16*****04** 16:00
It's only been twenty-eight days, and, as you mentioned, you know the website will get cleaned up, hasn't been cleaned up yet, and so, but the focus is on the other managed IT services security support, and so that's great to know, yeah.

 **Rick Snide** 16:03
Mhm.
Mhm.
Yeah, yeah.
So...

 **+16*****04** 16:21

Do you have sales team wise?
How many BDMs do you do you have?



Rick Snide 16:30

We have zero right now.



+16***04** 16:33

Oh, okay. Okay, so...



Rick Snide 16:34

So, it's really, it's really me.



+16***04** 16:39

Well, you know what? That's you getting out and grinding, right?



Rick Snide 16:43

Yeah, yeah. And which is good. I enjoy doing it. You know, the only thing, the only problem is I don't have the bandwidth to prospect, you know, and, you know, that's I mean, that's probably not the only problem, but I do have other things I need to get done. And really, it's important to have somebody, somebody, you know, dedicated to sales, you know, 24-7.



+16***04** 17:15

Oh yeah.

I would imagine you're stretched a little thin.



Rick Snide 17:20

Yeah, yeah, and we, I don't know if Ken told you this story, but I hired a, so I let our sales rep that we did have go after two years, she just wasn't going to grasp it, it seems.



+16***04** 17:22

A...



Rick Snide 17:40

So I had I let her go at the beginning of the year and I had hired a guy who ended up being actually a total con man. He he he was he was.

 **+16*****04** 17:54
Ohh, jeez.

 **Rick Snide** 17:57
Also hired it at.

 **+16*****04** 17:58
Off.

 **Rick Snide** 18:00
at least one other company, but I think two other companies. And so he was working all three of us at the same time, or at least all two of us at the same time. So.

 **+16*****04** 18:05
No.
Holy cow, that sounds like a couple of individuals I know during the pandemic that were working remote and they had four and five different gigs going.

 **Rick Snide** 18:22
Yeah, it's a...
It's a lot to juggle. You know, my mother, one of the things that I always remember that my mother said to me when I was younger, and I don't remember if she said it to me because she needed to or if it was because of something I did, but I do remember what she said was, you know, if you never lie or if you don't lie,

 **+16*****04** 18:25
Okay.
Yeah.

 **Rick Snide** 18:44
You never have to remember your story. And I always wonder how these people that

are pulling this stuff off keep their stories straight on what they're doing. And, you know, it's, yeah.

 **+16*****04** 18:56

It's amazing, isn't it? I mean, yeah, it's, but I think my mom and your mom probably would get along because I heard the same thing pretty much my entire life and it always stayed with me. Well,

 **Rick Snide** 18:59

Yeah.

Yeah.

Heather.

Yeah.

Right, right. So, so I so he worked for us for like 3 days. And then since then, I actually was so completely consumed in selling this, the ERP consulting group.

 **+16*****04** 19:22

Expect with.

 **Rick Snide** 19:30

that I really just been, I've been not working overly hard to try to find a replacement. So, and we had a number of prospects that that I had some kind of relationship with, or at least had been in contact with, and I've just been continuing to work those. And we've closed a couple of deals since then. But I need, I really do need somebody full-time.

 **+16*****04** 19:59

Well...

I was gonna ask you, too, with the...

What the thing you do have?

the sales cycle.

 **Rick Snide** 20:11

Mhm.



+16*****04 20:12

On average, do you remember what it was, or can you tell me what it typically is? I know it's varied, obviously, but...

How long, how long did it take to?

I guess sign the papers for some of the clients that you do have.



Rick Snide 20:30

Mhm.

It's, you know, it does vary quite a bit.

The.

Kind of depends on whether the...

prospect has, you know, a particular pain they're trying to solve, or, you know, has a particular deadline they're trying to hit, like the end of a contract, you know, or something, you know, something that's pushing like that.

you know, somebody's retiring or, you know, there are, you know, it can be a variety of things. But I would say in general, it takes about.

Six to 8 weeks, beginning to end, you know.



+16*****04 21:21

Okay.



Rick Snide 21:22

You know, the, it depends, you know, and some, some companies, some kind of older school companies, you know, will do an RFP process, which, you know, it's at least predictable, but



+16*****04 21:22

No.



Rick Snide 21:40

You know that the the problem with RFPs, in my opinion, is...

It's not really...

It's not really easy to compare services like ours, you know, apples to apples with another.

You know, if you are really, if you really know what you're doing and can really look at multiple proposals and really understand how to compare them, you know, you're going to be a fairly technical person probably. And if you're not, you're just going to be comparing on price and not even really knowing what you're getting except for. that this price is better than that price, right? So...

 **+16*****04** 22:23
Sure.

 **Rick Snide** 22:24
you know, that's kind of the challenge is getting out and prospecting and, you know, finding the right kind of companies, you know, and like I said, really the right kinds are people that value their
Time value, their security, you know, and you know they, and they want a...

 **+16*****04** 22:48
What?
Sure.

 **Rick Snide** 22:57
you know, a partnership. So, you know, those are the kind of customers that we're looking for and preferably that are growing, you know, maybe have acquisition goals, you know, like we just took on a plumbing company.
and which is would not normally be my first choice of a company to take on. But everybody running the company has been put in there basically from the from private equity and they've got big plans to
You know, acquire several more and make a, and they've already they already had the branding plan in place of what they wanted to do, and I literally told him that in the sales call that you know that you know we we wouldn't typically just take on a...
You know, they wouldn't, I didn't say it negatively, but I said, you know, what I really liked about them, which would be different than a typical plumbing company, is that they want to grow, they have acquisition goals, they need a partner, and we want to be a partner. We don't want to be a vendor, you know, so

 **+16*****04** 23:57
Sure.

 **Rick Snide** 24:12
Um...

 **+16*****04** 24:12
Well, that's the key too, right? When you can be a partner, and you already know it, a true partner, those relationships, they're just, they start out on trust, they continue on performance and trust, and it's so much better than being considered a

 **Rick Snide** 24:14
Mhm.
Mm-hmm.

 **+16*****04** 24:32
you know, a vendor. I mean, it sounds negative. I know a lot of good firms, good vendors, but at the end of the day, they're in the same bucket with the other vendors.

 **Rick Snide** 24:34
Mm-hmm.
Mhm, mhm, mhm.

 **+16*****04** 24:47
So, that's always, yeah, that's always interesting. So, you're looking for a true, you need a hunter, correct?

 **Rick Snide** 24:54
Exactly. Yep, exactly. And you know, I'm really looking for somebody that's been or, you know, can confidently sell, you know, recurring.

 **+16*****04** 24:56
Okay.

Okay.

But...



Rick Snide 25:09

Contracts, you know, to that.

C-suite, if you will, you know, if you want to consider a, you know, a, you know, a 5, 10, \$20 million company, you know, is going to have a CFO and a CEO, maybe, maybe office manager, you know, some people like that, you know, in the co-managed model.



+16***04** 25:14

Oh.

Absolutely.

Absolutely.



Rick Snide 25:33

In the co-managed model, we're usually talking to, you know, the IT director or IT manager or somebody like that.

But you know, I'd be interested in, you know, what you've been doing, what you, how you've been selling, what you've been selling, and how you think that fits in with selling recurring managed services versus that.



+16***04** 25:47

What?

Absolutely. So, as I mentioned, it's been 25 years, actually going on 26th. within the IT community. And that started out as staffing, selling staffing services on the IT.



Rick Snide 26:20

Mhm.



+16***04** 26:20

As I, as I worked my way up, there was still the staffing portion of it, but the conversations.

I was having were with individuals that were decision makers. And so hearing the

landscape of different companies and some of the frustrations and some of the bottlenecks, if you will, within the infrastructure support areas at some of the companies.



Rick Snide 26:34

Mhm.



+16***04** 26:49

I worked at a few places selling and it's been across the landscape.

Selling managed IT services.

Selling the staffing, selling project-based work, selling statement of work.

The reoccurring contract, as you mentioned, was always at the forefront because of the relationships and because of the backgrounds.



Rick Snide 27:18

Tell me more about the, you said selling managed IT services. Tell me more about that. What, when you say you were selling that, what was that composed or comprised of? And you know, what's the size of the contract? What was included in that?



+16***04** 27:18

Certainly.

Yeah.

Yeah, I have that one.

Absolutely. And so those contracts were with, and that's one of the reasons why I wanted to ask, were with small to mid-sized

Clients.

Certainly not a nationwide or a Cardinal Heather, any of those, but some others.



Rick Snide 27:51

Mhm.



+16***04** 27:53

you would recognize, certainly. And so I was able to, and again, I'm a relationship

guy. I'm a hunter. But it's relationships and networking, connecting, having the conversations, finding out. What points of pain might be? What objectives might be?



Rick Snide 27:55

Mhm.

Mhm.

Mhm.



+16***04** 28:14

If they could improve anything in a couple of areas, you know, IT infrastructure model-wise, what would have the biggest impact? So, having those conversations, so...

I had worked a number of years ago at a company that was called Air Works. I don't know if you're familiar with them.



Rick Snide 28:33

Yeah, yep, I know them.



+16***04** 28:36

Okay, so...

Care Works became Sedgwick. Sedgwick bought Care Works.



Rick Snide 28:43

Mhm.



+16***04** 28:44

Out of that, spun a group which is still around today, great individuals called Star Seven Six.



Rick Snide 28:54

Okay.



+16***04** 28:55

Are you, are you familiar with them and all?



Rick Snide 28:56

I don't know. I think I lost touch with them after Care Works.



+16***04** 29:02

Okay.

So, part of what I was selling was the manage IT services.

But the selling portion of it came from the relationships and the conversations and the new contacts that I had. We had a group.

Where I could come back with what I thought were opportunities. Hey, I just had this conversation with so-and-so.

This is what was mentioned.

They're interested in talking with us about this, this, and this.



Rick Snide 29:35

Mhm.



+16***04** 29:36

Then we have what we had at the time, SMEs. So I would facilitate those meetings and those conversations. And again, just learning the different questions to ask, you know, something as basic as meeting with other firms, talking with other firms.



Rick Snide 29:51

Mm-hmm.

Mhm.



+16***04** 30:14

Just getting those in, so when I say selling managed services, that's what I mean with. Facilitating.



Rick Snide 30:24

Mhm.



+16***04** 30:24

The opportunities and the meetings and bringing in our subject matter experts and letting it run its course. Now, some of those contracts.



Rick Snide 30:34

So, what would it?

Yeah, go ahead. Maybe you're going to answer my question. I was, I think maybe you were going there. I was going to ask, so what give me an example of some of those agreements that you sold, what the size was and what the term was of the of that agreement, and you know what was included in it?



+16***04** 30:37

Go ahead.

Absolutely.

Okay.

In.

Absolutely. And I do not have it in front of me. I'd have to go off my memory. I certainly can go back at the notes that I have. I think there were some that were for two years.

Initially, I think there were some that were 12 months initially, and then extended out to 36 months and 48 months.



Rick Snide 31:13

Mm-hmm.

Mhm.



+16***04** 31:24

Size-wise.

My apologies, I'd have to go back in and look at some of the notes.



Rick Snide 31:31

Are you thinking, I mean, just wild estimate, what would you say the monthly amount was?



+16***04** 31:38

A monthly amount, anywhere between 45 and 60,000. And that's, again, off the top of my head.



Rick Snide 31:44

Okay.



+16***04** 31:48

I.



Rick Snide 31:49

So what's included in a 40 to \$60,000 a month managed service for 12 months? What are you doing at that point? What are you providing for that?



+16***04** 32:03

Infrastructure support, there was some security that was involved. You had mentioned security. Some of that was involved. Some of it, again, having somebody be able to go out on site, especially here in Dublin. And some that was, you know, remote.



Rick Snide 32:07

Mhm.

Mhm.

Mm-hmm.

Okay. And B, so you're, so there was a, sounds to me like there's a fair amount of staffing included in that.



+16***04** 32:27

The.

No, no, not a fair amount. Not, I wouldn't, I wouldn't say that a fair amount, no.



Rick Snide 32:36

No.

So, all of that, so...

What is what is happening? I mean, what's included in in that when you say like 40, so like 40,000 a month to me sounds like it's.

You know, even if it's projects, are you sending, I mean, are there like...
Eight.

SMEs that are out trying to get, you know, trying to solve all of those particular items that you brought up in conversation. Is that what they're doing during that during that time frame?

 **+16*****04** 33:21

Yeah, it was actually 3 SMEs.

 **Rick Snide** 33:23

Mhm.

 **+16*****04** 33:25

Yes, sir.

 **Rick Snide** 33:28

And they just go, you know, so that, so the customer would essentially. have an agreement of going to have these three people and we've got all of these items that we've decided we want to accomplish and these people are there to accomplish those items.

 **+16*****04** 33:50

Yes. And to have more conversations around other areas or other points or objectives that the client was hoping to get done.

 **Rick Snide** 33:55

Mhm.

Mhm.

Okay. And that didn't, that doesn't fall into staffing though, huh? How does that not fall into like a staffing?

 **+16*****04** 34:11

Well, our our our staffing's traditionally, if you're sending out...



Rick Snide 34:11

Bucket.



+16***04** 34:19

or placing Java developers or .NET developers, or you have business analysts or Python developers. That's what I refer to as the staffing portion.



Rick Snide 34:23

Mhm.

I gotcha.

I gotcha.



+16***04** 34:36

Hopefully that makes sense. I mean, I may not be articulating it well, but hopefully it makes sense.



Rick Snide 34:38

But.

Hmm.

Yeah, I think I'm getting the picture now, I think. So it sounds to me like there's basically a dividing line between where you're providing resources for a specific skill that are going to be part of a team or whatever managed by the customer to.

You know, develop software or whatever, compared to compared to you're putting, you're sending people that are more of a consultant to level out to solve problems.



+16***04** 35:06

Exactly.



Rick Snide 35:18

for a particular time frame. Would that be right?



+16***04** 35:22

That'd be fair, sure.



Rick Snide 35:24

Okay.

Yeah, I'm just trying to, trying to make sure I understand. So, um, did, did you, did you, um...

Did you have a particular?

Quota of selling the managed services? Did you have a a quota for overall? How did that how did that work?



+16***04** 35:51

Yeah, so if I go back and I'm looking at it, remembering it, so it was 100,000 to 120,000 per quarter.



Rick Snide 36:04

Mm-hmm.



+16***04** 36:05

on the managed services.



Rick Snide 36:08

Mhm, Okay.

And would you say you're primarily selling that to Enterprise? Level customers.



+16***04** 36:21

Yes.



Rick Snide 36:22

Yeah.



+16***04** 36:23

Yes, I would, yes.



Rick Snide 36:26

They would seem like be the only ones that could afford something like that.

 +16*****04 36:33

You did well. I was getting ready. I was getting ready to say.

 **Rick Snide** 36:34

I mean, some larger mid-market could.

 +16*****04 36:38

Yeah, I was getting ready to say you'd be surprised, but I'm not going to tell you you'd be surprised. So yeah.
Yeah.

 **Rick Snide** 36:48

Yeah, so do you, um, so...

 +16*****04 36:49

Yeah.

 **Rick Snide** 36:53

The our typical deal is a 36-month deal and is.

 +16*****04 36:54

Yeah.

Okay.

 **Rick Snide** 37:06

Is between...

Ohh, I would say...

3500 to...

Ten 1000.

You know, the... Mm-hmm. And...

 +16*****04 37:21

Really?

Yeah.



Rick Snide 37:27

That's per month, obviously. The...



+16***04** 37:30

Oh, sure.



Rick Snide 37:33

And it's typically, like I said, a fully managed arrangement where we're providing all of the help desk remotely. In some cases, we include or package in some amount of on-site support if they've, if we're taking over for.

somebody like maybe they're, maybe they have a help desk person and they're, that person's leaving and now this is why they're talking to us. We might put someone out there for, you know, as a part of the package for.

a few days a week, maybe winding that down till they get used to, instead of having one person that they can walk up to in the office there to get help, you know, trying to get them into the groove of, you know, emailing us or calling or chatting with us for support. So we'll do that.

But basically, we provide that.

help desk level support 24-7, and we will, we have an account manager that's assigned to them that is kind of the coordinator of their services, and they will meet with them monthly, unless they're really small and then maybe it's quarterly.

But meet with them monthly to review what their goals are, what the budget is, you know, trying to help them best utilize their IT dollars to continue to get the technology improvements that they need to take care of, you know, initiatives that they have about, you know, maybe moving to a new office or, you know,

you know, acquiring another company or whatever. So we will do that as a part of our security management. We will also have a maturity. You don't hear all that noise in the background, do you?



+16***04** 39:48

I do not, no.



Rick Snide 39:49

OK, good, good. I've got there's a somebody talking really loudly about 50 feet away from me here, and I my microphone usually takes it out, but...

 **+16*****04** 39:51

Yeah.

The.

But.

 **Rick Snide** 40:05

So, anyway, they, so we...

We do obviously 24-7 security management, but then we're also trying to always continue to mature that model. So, you know, helping them keep moving forward so they stay protected, stay protected.

And we monitor all of that, so that if anything does happen, we can notify them right away, but we also are...

Are scanning their network, scanning their systems, and continually trying to see how we can improve their security, and then we're delivering that to them as a, "Here's where you basically, here's what we've been doing over the last."

X amount of time.

And here's what we think we need to do in terms of projects to move you forward, both security projects and general technology projects. And we'll have those kind of meetings, you know, monthly with them.

 **+16*****04** 41:18

Sure.

Are you, are you relaying? Ohh, I'm sorry, I'm sorry, go ahead.

 **Rick Snide** 41:25

No, I was saying we do that monthly with them.

 **+16*****04** 41:28

When you say we do that, is that yourself or do you have other individuals or where is it being on the base being touched? Who's relaying that information?

 **Rick Snide** 41:44

So, we have.

We've got the help desk staff, which is a level one, level 2, level 3 of engineers, you know, that are basically handling incoming user support issues on one hand.

All of level one is handling user support issues, and then they get escalated to level 2, level 3, level 2, and level 3 that are also managing system-driven issues, so you know this server's reporting that you know it's having problems and...

You know, there.

You know, we'll automatically create a ticket and our level 2, level 3 people will take that on. Also, our security analysis of what's going on at this customer and with their systems and etc. that will create tickets for our level 2, level 3 team that will be.

digging in to see what we can do there. And then we've got a project team, a projects team, which focuses on doing those projects that we propose to customers.

And then the account management team, which is 3 people plus a procurement person, will.

have those monthly meetings and those monthly meetings then that input for those monthly meetings in terms of security and strategy will be some of that is delivered by the account management team and

And created by the account management team, and the bulk of it is created by the people on the projects team that perform or provide the kind of the virtual CIO function of.

Knowing where each of these customers are, strategy-wise and security-wise, and what do we need to do to keep moving them forward, so there...

doing both the tactical and the strategic work of educating the account manager on what needs to happen there. And then they also are then pulled in as SMEs, you know, for various conversations with the customers on.

you know, why they need to do something or why we're recommending something, you know, to keep that moving along.



+16***04** 44:36

Oh, okay. Well, thank you for sharing that.



Rick Snide 44:39

Yeah, yeah, so...

Um...

So yeah, the.

I think the bigger challenge here is prospecting, you know, finding people to propose to. You know, that's always been the challenge. It used to be a little bit easier when people answered their phones.

 **+16*****04** 45:05

The.

Yeah, you're telling me.

 **Rick Snide** 45:09

But...

Yeah, yeah, so tell me, how, how are you, how are you getting leads now?

 **+16*****04** 45:19

It's all over the board, but focus all over the board. So my leads will come from networking events.

 **Rick Snide** 45:24

Mhm.

Mhm.

 **+16*****04** 45:29

They will come from, as I mentioned, meetings or conversations. They will come from emails that are sent out. Most of the time, those don't get read.

Sometimes I do, right?

 **Rick Snide** 45:44

Like you mean like nurture emails from your marketing department?

 **+16*****04** 45:49

Yeah, we have what we use is HubSpot. So the emails will go out through there depending on if I see something on LinkedIn. And I still think LinkedIn is great for finding some places that are in need.

 **Rick Snide** 46:00

Mm-hmm.

Mhm.

 **+16*****04** 46:09

and are perhaps putting it out there. Does anybody know if anybody for this? And many firms for this. But it could be everything. And I've gone to cricket matches here in Columbus because I knew us.

 **Rick Snide** 46:15

Mhm.

Mhm.

 **+16*****04** 46:28

CIO.

who at the time was the place I was trying to get into and sat through a day of cricket and ended up making some relationships, getting some meetings, and turning it into business. So I like to think all over the board when it comes to, you know, getting leads.

 **Rick Snide** 46:34

Mhm.

Hmm.

 **+16*****04** 46:50

but being focused with getting those leads, right? Bad business, bad business doesn't change. I don't want bad business. But as we talked about.

 **Rick Snide** 46:54

Mhm, mhm.

Mm-hmm.

 **+16*****04** 47:02

If I can be a partner, that's my ultimate goal. I want to be...



Rick Snide 47:06

Mhm.



+16***04** 47:08

Hey, Phil, this is what we're thinking about. This is what we're looking at. Can your firm help?



Rick Snide 47:15

Mm-hmm.



+16***04** 47:15

Let's talk, so...



Rick Snide 47:18

How, how?



+16***04** 47:18

Yeah, I'd like it. Go ahead.



Rick Snide 47:21

I was just wondering how...

How much for, I know maybe staffing is pretty specific, but I'm wondering, how much do you have to know about the technologies and all at this point?



+16***04** 47:30

It.

Well, I'd like to think that I can have a conversation, right? As I mentioned before, I'm not a technical person per se. Yes, I'm business development manager, but I need to be able to know.



Rick Snide 47:54

Mhm.



+16***04** 48:01

what I'm talking about in an initial conversation.
or a second conversation and going back to whether it's a team that we talked about
or moving a process along, I can't have, you know, gain the trust of a potential client
if they come away from meeting with me saying,



Rick Snide 48:09

Mhm.

Mhm.



+16***04** 48:26

Great guy. I'm not sure he knows what he's talking about. So that's a long answer to
a question for you, but that's where I'm at with it.



Rick Snide 48:29

Mhm.

Mmh.

Do you, um...

Do you?

Find yourself having to talk about a particular technology, or you know, like when
you're doing one of these managed agreements, you know, how are you talking
about?

you know, product licensing and cloud servers and things like that. What do you,
how much do you need to do that?



+16***04** 49:09

I need to be able to speak to it.



Rick Snide 49:12

Mhm.



+16***04** 49:12

percentage-wise.

I couldn't tell you, but I need to be able to speak to it, and I need to be able to at
least articulate on a couple of items. Now, a lot of...



Rick Snide 49:19

Mhm.



+16***04** 49:27

A lot of those conversations, I am also listening to what the individual or the target or the client.

Is saying, so I, I try and do the...

Ninety-ten rule, or I'm listening 90% of the time. No, I have never been one to go in and just be a bull in a china shop. I try and do my research.



Rick Snide 49:45

Mhm.

Mhm.



+16***04** 49:56

I do my research, and I have that, but I wanna hear what is going on with the client, the target, the individual.



Rick Snide 50:07

Mhm, mhm.

Right.

The.

If you like your most recent.

sale that you would say was pretty technical. Can you just tell me about what that one would sound like?



+16***04** 50:26

Sure, I can tell you and on the technical portion of it.



Rick Snide 50:37

Mhm.



+16***04** 50:38

Check on a second meeting.

But I can tell you I was sitting across from the president and CEO of a collections company.



Rick Snide 50:51

Mhm.



+16***04** 50:51

And, as, as I'm talking with her.

I see other individuals coming in the room and whispering to her and then she's got a panicked look on her face.

And I had just said, hey, we can certainly reschedule if you would like. It seems like something might be gone.

Said our phones are down.



Rick Snide 51:18

Mm.



+16***04** 51:18

And at present at the present time.

We are losing whatever amount it was.

per hour that the phones were down. So obviously, her company, her baby, is affecting the bottom line.



Rick Snide 51:27

Mm.

Mhm.



+16***04** 51:33

And so I said, "Well, let let me just..."

See something, maybe you want to help without any other things. Let me, let me just see, might be able to help.

Made a call back to our security person and our SME and he said, not sure what's happening. Here's what's playing out.

Can you come out and meet with her with me?

Eat it.

At a meeting.

Turns out there was a security issue with all of their phones and their computers, and what they had was somebody had walked out the door that was responsible.



Rick Snide 52:16

Mm.



+16***04** 52:23

For that one person, and they had left and just left everything in disarray for this company, so...

They ended up outsourcing, for lack of a better word, or doing an agreement with us to handle all of their infrastructure.



Rick Snide 52:43

Mhm.



+16***04** 52:43

all of the phones, all the security. It was a great story. I love telling it. So...



Rick Snide 52:49

Mm.

Mm-hmm.



+16***04** 52:52

Yeah, and again, that was, you know, that was a meeting, and I'm not.



Rick Snide 52:52

Gotcha.



+16***04** 52:58

As I mentioned, I'm not a technical person, so I wasn't about to say, well, hang on, let me take a look. It might be this, this, and this. I don't, uh-uh.



Rick Snide 53:05

Right, right, right.



+16***04** 53:06

Made a call, made a call back.

Got our individual out there.

Had a conversation with the owner and turned into a great partnership, great client.



Rick Snide 53:18

Yeah, good, good.

Well, where?

About out of time here. I want to be respectful of your time.



+16***04** 53:27

Oh, sure.



Rick Snide 53:29

I think.

I'd like to...

Maybe.

connect you with another person at our firm and let you chat with her as well and just kind of spend a little bit more time with each other and you know get to know each other a little bit more and more about the services and

You know more about what your background is here, and just kind of...



+16***04** 53:56

I think that'd be great.



Rick Snide 54:01

Keep the conversation going if you're if you're up for that.



+16***04** 54:05

I would love that. Yeah, I would love, and whether that's, you know, a Teams call or something like today with a, you know, cell call, and again, thanks for the flexibility, or it's, you know, grabbing some coffee somewhere. I'd love to continue the conversation.



Rick Snide 54:24

Right, right. Well, let me, um, let me, uh...
connect you. I'll connect you with her. That's Cindy. She's our marketing director.



+16***04** 54:38

Okay.



Rick Snide 54:39

Let me, let me connect you with her, and...



+16***04** 54:40

Yeah.



Rick Snide 54:42

You guys can figure out what works best. I think probably I would say that probably, you know, start with a Teams meeting and we go from there and...



+16***04** 54:51

Okay.



Rick Snide 54:55

But uh, I'll let you two work out a time, and uh, we'll uh, we'll just keep, we'll just keep talking, and uh...



+16***04** 55:04

No, that'd be great, and I, you know, I'd shared with Ken one of the, and I'll be brief with this, but you know, one of the driving forces is kind of why when he reached out to me, I wanted to talk to him about the opportunity is...



Rick Snide 55:05

See what works.



+16***04** 55:23

No, I am on my 4th.
VP of Sales in 10 months.



Rick Snide 55:31

Wow.



+16***04** 55:32

And so that's exactly what Ken said. And so that kind of instability with direction of this is what we're doing. Okay, let's move the goalposts over here. You know, that's quite a bit of change.



Rick Snide 55:51

Mhm.



+16***04** 55:51

At that level, for you know, within 10 months.



Rick Snide 55:55

Mhm, yeah.



+16***04** 55:57

Yep, so anyways.



Rick Snide 55:57

Yeah.

Yeah, that's a little unsettling.



+16***04** 56:03

It's unsettling. Yeah, that's a great word for it. So that'd be great. You said her name is Cindy?



Rick Snide 56:09

Cindy.

 **+16*****04** 56:11
Cindy, okay, well, I looked.

 **Rick Snide** 56:12
Actually, actually, Cindy Snide, it's my wife. She's my wife. So, yep, yep.

 **+16*****04** 56:16
Ohh, ohh, it is OK. Well, I, I look forward to the introduction. I look forward to talking with her and look forward to talking with you again at some point as well.

 **Rick Snide** 56:27
Yeah, sounds good. I enjoyed speaking with you today, Phil. I look forward to talking some more.

 **+16*****04** 56:29
Yeah.
I enjoyed speaking with you as well, and thanks again for your time.

 **Rick Snide** 56:38
Yep, same here. We'll talk soon.

 **+16*****04** 56:40
Up.
Have a great afternoon. Take care.

 **Rick Snide** 56:42
You too. Thanks. Bye bye.

 **+16*****04** 56:44
Bye.

● **Rick Snide** stopped transcription